

Name: _____ Date: _____ Score: _____ / 30

Reading Comprehension Test

The Secret of the Swamp King - The Wilderking Trilogy, Book 2
by Jonathan Rogers

Directions: Circle the letter of the best answer for each question.

Section 1: Easy

1. At the beginning of the story, where is Aidan living?

- A. At the court of King Darrow
- B. In Greasy Cave with the miners
- C. On a hidden island in Feechiefen
- D. At Bayard's traveling camp

2. Who has become Aidan's close friend in King Darrow's household?

- A. Maynard, Aidan's jealous older brother from Longleaf
- B. Gustus
- C. Prince Steren
- D. Lord Radnor

3. What is King Darrow's attitude toward Aidan as the book begins?

- A. He trusts Aidan more than every other adviser.
- B. He grows suspicious and jealous of Aidan's popularity.
- C. He ignores Aidan because Aidan is too young to matter.
- D. He worries that Aidan will leave court and forget Corenwald.

4. What does King Darrow send Aidan to find?

- A. A lost royal crown
- B. A silver-feathered bog owl
- C. A map of Pyrthen tunnels
- D. A frog orchid

5. Where must Aidan go on King Darrow's dangerous errand?

- A. Across the Pyrthen border
- B. Into Feechiefen Swamp
- C. Back to Longleaf Manor
- D. Under Tambluff Castle

6. What name do many Feechiefolk know Aidan by?

- A. Pantherbane
- B. Bog Owl, because he can imitate the strange call from the swamp
- C. Swamp King
- D. Slingmaster

7. Which friend from the first book is especially important to Aidan among the Feechiefolk?

- A. Steren, because he follows Aidan all the way into Feechiefen
- B. Bayard
- C. Greidawl
- D. Dobro Turtlebane

8. What does Darrow believe will probably happen to Aidan in Feechiefen?

- A. Aidan will become a Pyrthen general.
- B. Aidan will return with a larger army.
- C. Aidan will die before coming back.
- D. Aidan will convince the swamp to become farmland.

9. What is the frog orchid supposed to cure?

- A. King Darrow's melancholy
- B. Steren's wounded leg
- C. Dobro's fear of civilizers
- D. Aidan's mark from the Feechiees

10. What kind of person does Aidan discover deep in the swamp?

- A. A lost Pyrthen prince
- B. A false Wilderking
- C. A silent royal librarian
- D. A retired Truthspeaker

Section 2: Medium**11. Why does Aidan volunteer to help King Darrow even though Darrow's mood is darkening?**

- A. He wants to embarrass Prince Steren in front of the court.
- B. He hopes to prove that Bayard was wrong about the prophecy.
- C. He still wants to serve his king faithfully.
- D. He plans to claim the throne as soon as he returns.

12. Why is Darrow's errand more dangerous than an ordinary journey?

- A. Darrow has forbidden every courtier from speaking to Aidan.
- B. The road to Longleaf has been blocked by jealous royal guards.
- C. Steren refuses to let Aidan carry any supplies.
- D. No Corenwald is known for returning safely from Feechiefen.

13. How does Aidan's friendship with the Feechiefolk change his chances in the swamp?

- A. It lets him avoid every danger without needing courage.
- B. It gives him allies who know the wild country better than civilizers do.
- C. It proves he no longer cares about Corenwald, King Darrow, or the people he once defended.
- D. It makes Darrow proud of Aidan for the first time.

14. Why is Aidan's title Pantherbane important in this book?

- A. It gives Aidan the legal right to command Darrow's soldiers.
- B. It is the secret password to King Darrow's hidden treasure room beneath Tambluff Castle.
- C. It means Aidan has promised never to return to civilizer lands.
- D. It reminds the Feechiefolk that Aidan once helped Dobro at real cost.

15. What does Darrow's jealousy reveal about his character?

- A. He is afraid of losing honor and control to someone more loved.
- B. He values Corenwald's safety above his own reputation, comfort, royal authority, and praise from others.
- C. He has decided to stop being king and become a prophet.
- D. He trusts Aidan completely but dislikes Steren.

16. What makes Steren's friendship with Aidan difficult for Darrow?

- A. It gives Darrow a reason to send Steren away from Tambluff before the court can admire Aidan.

- B. It proves Steren wants to become a Feechie chief.
- C. It makes Aidan look connected to the royal family as well as loved by the people.
- D. It causes Bayard to abandon his prophecy.

17. Why does the false Wilderking pose a threat larger than one person's pride?

- A. He owns all the orchids and refuses to sell any to Corenwald.
- B. He owns all the orchids in Feechiefen and refuses to share any of them with Corenwald.
- C. He plans to teach the Feechiefolk to stop laughing and fighting.
- D. He confuses people about true leadership and endangers the order of the swamp.

18. What does Dobro's rescue attempt show about him?

- A. He wants to replace Aidan as King Darrow's favorite.
- B. He is loyal enough to risk trouble for Aidan.
- C. He is secretly working for the false Wilderking.
- D. He thinks friendship matters only when it is easy.

19. What problem grows when Dobro tries to help Aidan?

- A. Conflict breaks out among Feechie groups.
- B. King Darrow immediately invades Feechiefen.
- C. The frog orchids all disappear from the swamp.
- D. Prince Steren refuses to speak to Aidan again.

20. Why is finding the frog orchid not enough to fix King Darrow?

- A. Aidan gives the flower to the Pyrthens instead.
- B. The flower only works on Feechiefolk, not civilizers.
- C. Darrow's deepest problem is not simply a missing medicine.
- D. Bayard burns the flower before Aidan reaches court.

21. How does Aidan respond to Darrow's unfairness for most of the story?

- A. He gathers an army to overthrow Darrow at once.
- B. He stops caring about Corenwald and joins the false Wilderking.
- C. He keeps trying to be loyal without pretending Darrow is right.
- D. He refuses all help from Bayard, Steren, and Dobro.

22. What does the swamp setting help reveal about Aidan?

- A. He is willing to learn from strange people and dangerous places.
- B. He cannot lead unless the path is clean and comfortable.
- C. He prefers court praise to adventure, loyal friendship, and hard lessons in the wild swamp.
- D. He has forgotten the skills that helped him in the first book.

23. Why does Aidan's return with the orchid make Darrow angrier instead of grateful?

- A. The orchid wilts before Aidan can carry it back to court.
- B. The orchid turns out to belong to Prince Steren's own garden.
- C. The Feechiefolk demand that Darrow crown Dobro king.
- D. Aidan's survival proves that Darrow's attempt to remove him failed.

24. What does the story suggest about courage?

- A. Courage means never needing help from strange allies.
- B. Courage can include fear, loyalty, and costly obedience.
- C. Courage means seeking praise before doing what is right.
- D. Courage disappears whenever a ruler acts unjustly.

25. Why is Aidan's position at court no longer secure by the end?

- A. Darrow's suspicion has hardened even after Aidan succeeds.
- B. Aidan decides he would rather become a Pyrthen soldier.
- C. Steren publicly denies that he ever knew Aidan.
- D. Bayard declares that Aidan was never part of the prophecy.

Section 3: Hard

26. Which statement best explains the book's idea of grace?

- A. Grace means deserving every honor before accepting it.
- B. Grace means never suffering because of another person's jealousy.
- C. Grace means refusing ordinary duties until destiny becomes clear.
- D. Grace means receiving and living faithfully within what God has given.

27. How does Aidan contrast with the false Wilderking?

- A. Aidan trusts only civilizers, while the pretender honors the Feechiefolk.
- B. Aidan refuses adventure, while the pretender bravely serves King Darrow.
- C. Aidan seeks faithful service, while the pretender uses the Wilderking name for power.
- D. Aidan wins by royal wealth, while the pretender depends on honest friendship.

28. What larger pattern from David's life does the story reimagine through Aidan and Darrow?

- A. A prophet builds a temple after defeating an invading empire.
- B. A young deliverer remains loyal while a jealous king turns against him.
- C. A prince becomes king by hiding from every hard responsibility.
- D. A shepherd refuses friendship because he wants court praise.

29. Why is the frog orchid a fitting object for Aidan's quest?

- A. It is dangerous because it makes anyone who smells it become king.
- B. It proves that the swamp is valuable only when civilizers control it.
- C. It gives Aidan the legal right to command Darrow's army.
- D. It is beautiful and healing, but it cannot cure a heart that rejects grace.

30. What does Aidan's journey into Feechiefen prepare him for?

- A. A life in which leadership will require humility, loyalty, courage, and exile.
- B. A future where he can safely avoid conflict by staying at court.
- C. A rule based mainly on fear, revenge, and public admiration.
- D. A decision to reject Corenwald because its king has treated him unfairly.